

needed to be the content that inspired the readers to comment, but we also wanted to give something extra to our readers. There are a few websites that feature their top commenters on the sidebar, but our sidebar didn't have enough space, and I was in search of something more space-efficient yet richer in returns.

5. If you want to increase the depth of navigation in your website, it is always a good idea to feature 'Related Articles' on every page. That way, you give your readers a way to read more on their preferred topics, without having to wade through a lot of irrelevant search results.
6. We also wanted an 'About the Author' section that is present in the magazine. The default WordPress installation doesn't provide that feature, and we went in search of a plug-in that could give us that functionality.
7. Conversations become more personal and engaging once you have a face to identify them with. This belief gave me the idea of including images for every commenter and also for the authors.
8. These days, while incorporating social bookmarking buttons in your content pages has become a fad, it has also become a necessity. Social bookmarking is a great way to get your content featured on other sites, in turn increasing your page views. While there are a lot of services like Share-a-holic, Quick Share and Tell-A-friend that provide such buttons and functionalities, most of them actually make your site look ugly rather than enhancing it. We were in search of something classier.
9. By default 'The Stars' theme had the same CSS style rules for both the `<pre>` and `<code>` tags, while our requirement was for them to be different. So, even that needed to be changed.
10. *LFY* has published a lot of articles in the past that have been co-authored by multiple writers. We needed to figure out a way to incorporate

that feature into our website since WordPress doesn't have that functionality, by default.

Development tools used

- **gHPEdit:** PHP, formerly the 'Personal Home Page' tools and now the 'PHP Hypertext Preprocessor' (celebrating the hacker tradition of recursive acronyms), is a scripting language for the Web with a gigantic following. It's also ideal for other general-purpose coding chores. Programs for hacking C, HTML and other languages have existed for some time; now PHP is starting to see its own dedicated software, and gHPEdit is looking notably strong here. What's more, gHPEdit also provides assisted development for CSS and HTML. It offers syntax highlighting, code completion and also tons of plug-ins to customise it the way you want it.
- **Firebug:** For any Web developer, there can not be any life without Firebug. Firebug is a free Mozilla Firefox add-on that gives developers a powerful tool to inspect and edit HTML, perfect CSS, or even admire the beautiful code from other websites. For many, the add-on has become an indispensable part of website design, development and maintenance.

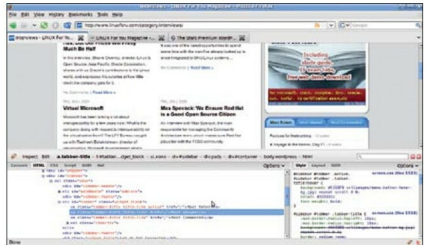
Firebug provides a Box Model viewer, along with an improved inspector. Click on the HTML tab

in the left panel and the *Layout* tab in the right panel. The Box Model is displayed on the right while the HTML tree is displayed on the left. Start moving through the tree and as you hover over an HTML item, you'll notice the HTML in the browser window will be highlighted. Click on some text in the HTML tree. You can edit the HTML right there in Firebug.

You can even edit the CSS. Firebug provides you the ability to tweak your CSS while looking at the browser, so immediate adjustments can occur while editing the CSS – an excellent feature.

Well, truthfully, Firebug is a Web developer's Swiss army knife and deserves a complete article in itself. And if you are developing or theming for a CMS—such as Drupal, Joomla, WordPress or Blogspot—Firebug is an absolute essential tool. These applications comprise many files, and navigating through this maze can be daunting without a tool like Firebug. The beauty of content management systems is that you need not be a programmer to 'theme' a website, and you can typically do so without ever touching the programming code. But yes, you must be able to identify the controlling CSS to bring your own vision to the screen.

- **The GIMP:** Does it need an introduction?



Firebug in action